



AFTER

While the fall of Atlanta led to despair in the South, it sparked elation in the North. But Sherman's campaign in Georgia was not over. His next goal was the port of Savannah on the Atlantic coast.

LINCOLN'S RE-ELECTION

Not the news of [Farragut's sealing of Mobile Bay](#), nor that of [Sheridan's conquest of the Shenandoah Valley](#), indeed none of the good tidings for the North from 1864's fall of Union victories eclipsed the news of Sherman's capture of Atlanta. It had an electrifying effect on the North, and though Grant and Lee were still [entrenched before Petersburg](#), Lincoln's chances for re-election [see Lincoln Prevails](#) soared.

MARCH TO THE SEA

When Sherman occupied Atlanta, he continued the devastation begun by the Confederates themselves. Throughout October he built up supplies, and when he rode out of the city in November he embarked on a **trail of destruction across Georgia** [see Sherman's March to the Sea](#), to prove to the Southerners the **futility of further resistance**.

GRAND CONFEDERATE PLANS

After evacuating Atlanta, Hood planned to take the Army of Tennessee **north into Tennessee, cut Sherman's communications**, and either **invade the North** or cross the mountains to **reinforce Lee at Petersburg**. But his grandiose plans foundered at the **disastrous battles of** [Franklin and Nashville](#).